

SULFUR-ROT

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Summary

Those who spend most of their lives working on the exterior structures of **Theosis** often develop **Sulfur Rot**. Microscopic failures in pressure seals, sulfur residue trapped inside work gear, and years of repeated exposure allow traces of sulfur dioxide to reach the skin. Fingers, toes, ear tips, and other narrow extremities usually show the damage first. They blister and burn repeatedly, leaving the skin pale red, swollen, raw, and gum-like.

Sulfur Rot is a chronic chemical injury associated with exterior maintenance, atmospheric flight, pressure-envelope inspection, and work along the lower hulls of the buoyant cities.

A major suit breach receives immediate attention. The exposures that cause Sulfur Rot are smaller. A glove seal leaks during a long inspection. Sulfur dust remains inside a boot after decontamination. A pressure hood has been patched too many times. Emergency tape holds until the shift ends, and the worker returns the suit before anyone records the repair.

The earliest symptoms are itching, heat, and a persistent smell of burned sulfur inside the affected section of the suit. The skin reddens, blisters, and cracks along the joints. Repeated exposure thickens some areas while leaving others soft and easily torn. Advanced cases cause numbness, reduced dexterity, chronic swelling, and wounds that reopen whenever the worker returns outside.

Treatment generally consists of buffered chemical washes, regenerative dressings, tissue sealant, pain medication, and several weeks away from atmospheric exposure. Severe damage may require skin grafts, replacement digits, or permanent protective caps around the affected extremities. Many workers return to exterior duty before the tissue has fully healed.

Erbium medical offices frequently classify Sulfur Rot as an equipment-compliance injury unless the worker can provide a stamped record of a specific seal failure. Low-level leaks rarely trigger suit alarms, and emergency repairs performed during atmospheric disruptions may never enter the accepted maintenance record. Early cases are commonly treated as cosmetic until pain, reduced grip strength, or pressure intolerance begins to interfere with assigned work.

Among lower-deck crews, Sulfur Rot is easy to recognize. Affected workers wear thin gloves indoors, wrap tool handles in soft material, avoid hot decontamination water, and carry sharp-smelling neutralizing salves in their pockets. Some conceal the condition to protect their work clearance. Others leave the scars visible as proof of how many watches they have spent outside.